



Perceptual recoverability, articulatory efficiency & speech flexibility

- Speech production is often regarded as conditioned by:
 - Perceptual recoverability pressures
 - Articulatory efficiency pressures (Jun, 1995; Kirchner, 2001; Flemming, 2004; Cohen Priva, 2017)

Articulatory efficiency

Perceptual recoverability



Lower contrastiveness
Higher variability

Higher contrastiveness
Lower variability



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- Speech flexibility (i.e., motor equivalence; cf. Perrier & Fuchs 2015) suggests that the same target can be achieved through an array of motor movements.
- Certain degrees of freedom exist, allowing for an intended speech target to be achieved via an array of articulatory synergies.
 - Perceptual recoverability and articulatory efficiency could be achieved at the same time.
- Consequently, such flexibility may be a window for the speaker to react differently in the face of variable information-theoretic constraints in the articulatory & acoustic domains.

